

Joan Margalef

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Research Interests

Financial Economics, Conflict Studies, Development, and Applied Game Theory.

Education

Ph.D., Economics (cum laude), Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, 2025.

M.Res., Economics, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, 2020.

B.Eng., Industrial Organization, Escola Universitària Salesiana de Sarrià, 2017.

Professional Experience

Research Associate	Feb 2025 - Present
UNU-WIDER	Helsinki, Finland
Conduct academic research and contribute to policy reports on fragility, conflict, and development.	
<i>Tasks:</i> conduct independent research, contribute to World Bank report “Fragility and Poverty”, mentor PhD visiting fellows, and assist in project planning.	

Data Scientist (Consultant)	Sep 2022 - Aug 2023
EconAI - Fundació d’Economia Analítica	Barcelona, Spain
Conducted research on economic fragility measurement for the German Federal Foreign Office.	

Data Analyst (Consultant)	Jun 2021 - Aug 2022
Open Philanthropy	Barcelona, Spain
Quantified economic and health costs of conflict.	

Research

Publications

“[A Framework for Fragility: Guiding Measurement for Policy](#)” with Laura Mayoral, Hannes Mueller, and Christopher Rauh. *Policy Sciences*, 2026.

Working Papers

“[Caught in a Trap: Simulating the Economic Consequences of Conflict](#)” with Hannes Mueller

“[A Probabilistic Measure of State Fragility](#)”

“[Disaster Risk through Investors’ Eyes: A Yield Curve Analysis](#)”

“Coordination Effects among Global Games: An Application on Tax Havens”

Work in Progress

“Conflict and Economic Divergence”

Teaching

Lecturer

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona

- *Introduction to MATLAB* (Grad., 20h) 2024, 2025
- *Math Brush-Up* (Grad., 20h) 2024

Escola FUAB - Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona

- *Applied Statistics* (Undergrad., 50h) 2021
- *Introduction to Economics* (Undergrad., 50h) 2020

Teaching Assistant

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona

- *Game Theory* (Grad.) 2024
- *Contracts and Incentives* (Grad.) 2022
- *Microeconomics I* (Grad.) 2022

Barcelona School of Economics

- *Public Economics I* (Grad.) 2021–2023

Grants

Formación de Personal Investigador (FPI Grant) 2021 – 2025
Ministerio Español de Ciencia e Innovación

BSE-UAB IDEA PhD Track Fellowship 2019 – 2020
Barcelona Graduate School of Economics

Professional Activities

Referee Service

Civil Wars, Peace and Sustainability (NERPS).

Presentations

2025: WB & UNU-WIDER: Poverty and Fragility Workshop, UNU-WIDER: Tax & Conflict Workshop, UNU-WIDER: Brown Bag Seminar. **2024:** UNU-WIDER: The Road at Crossroads (Mozambique), III Catalan Economic Society Congress, UPF-PhD Workshop, IDEA MacroClub. **2023:** BSE Jamboree, Bellaterra MicroLab. **2022:** Bellaterra MicroLab. **2021:** Red Española de Elección Social, Bellaterra MicroLab.

Skills

Languages: Spanish (Native), Catalan (Native), English (Fluent), Italian (Advanced)

Software: Python, R, Matlab, Stata, and L^AT_EX.